

MEM FOX

WHOEVER YOU ARE



ILLUSTRATED BY LESLIE STAUB

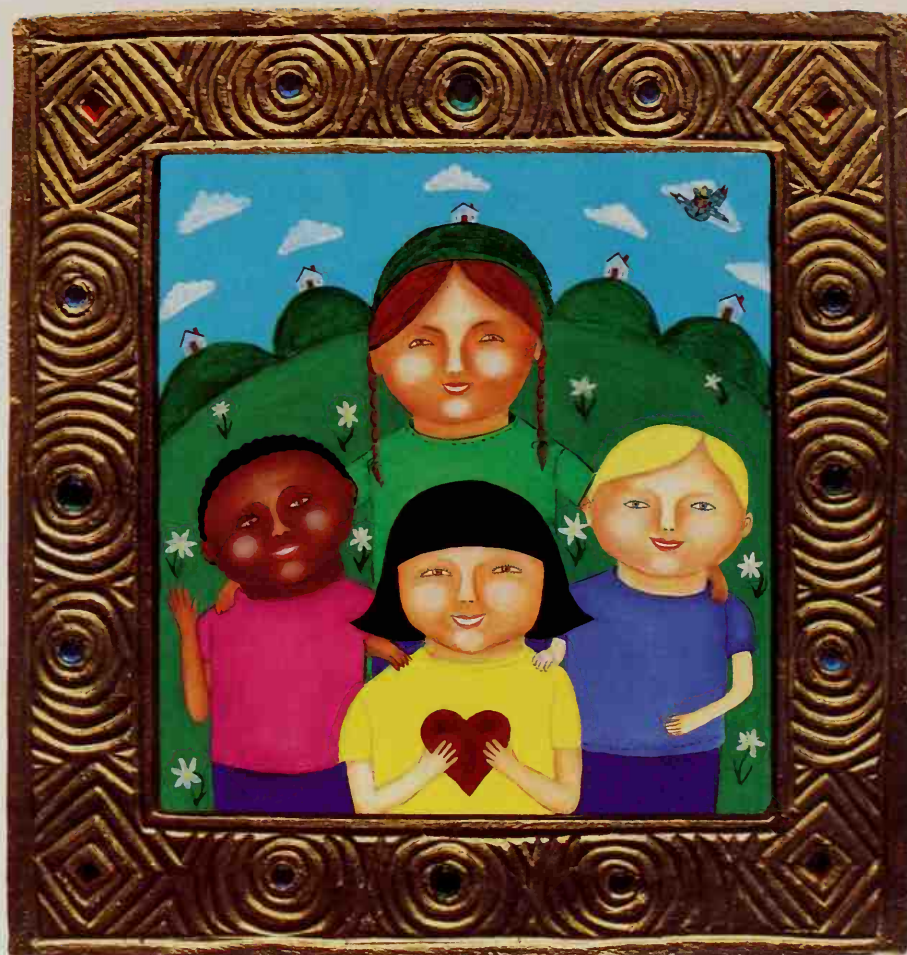


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By MEM FOX

Illustrated by LESLIE STAUB

SCHOLASTIC INC.

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The illustrations in this book were done in oil on gessoed paper.

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*The text type was set in Monotype Goudy Bold
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Production supervision by Stanley Redfern and Ginger Boyer

Designed by Judythe Sieck



For Hanan Ashrawi
—M. F.

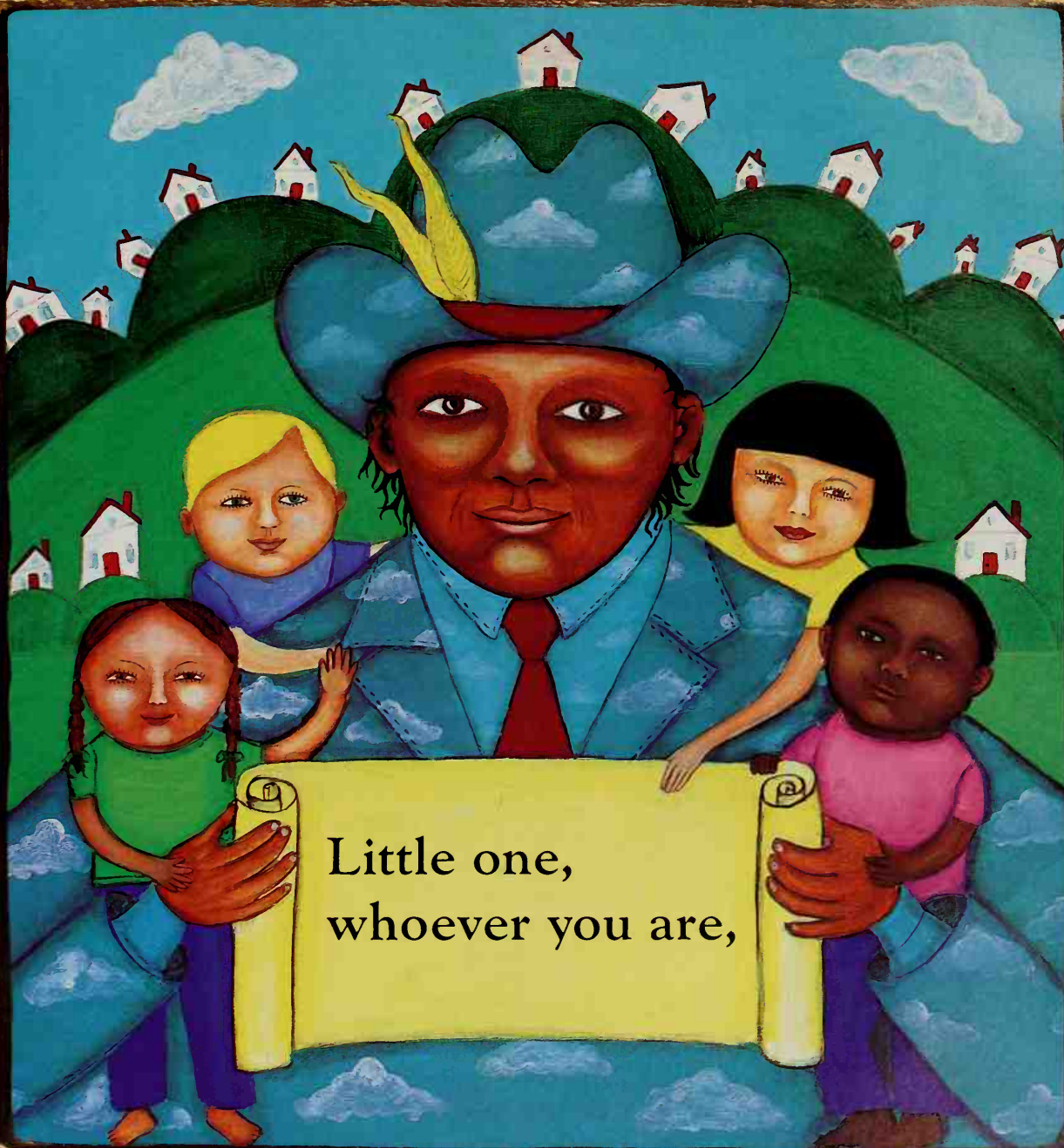
*For YaYa
and for you,
whoever you are*
—L. S.



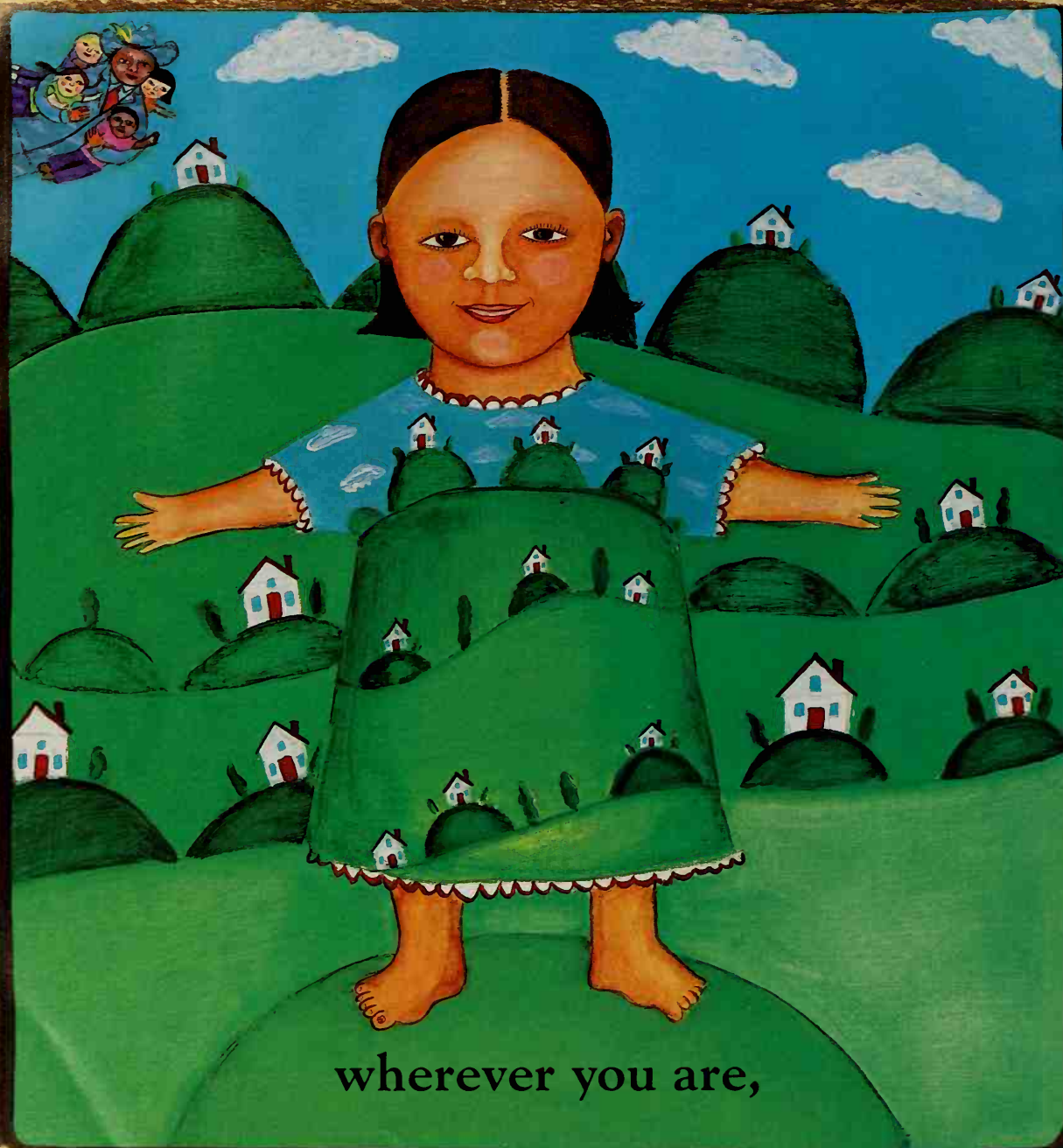


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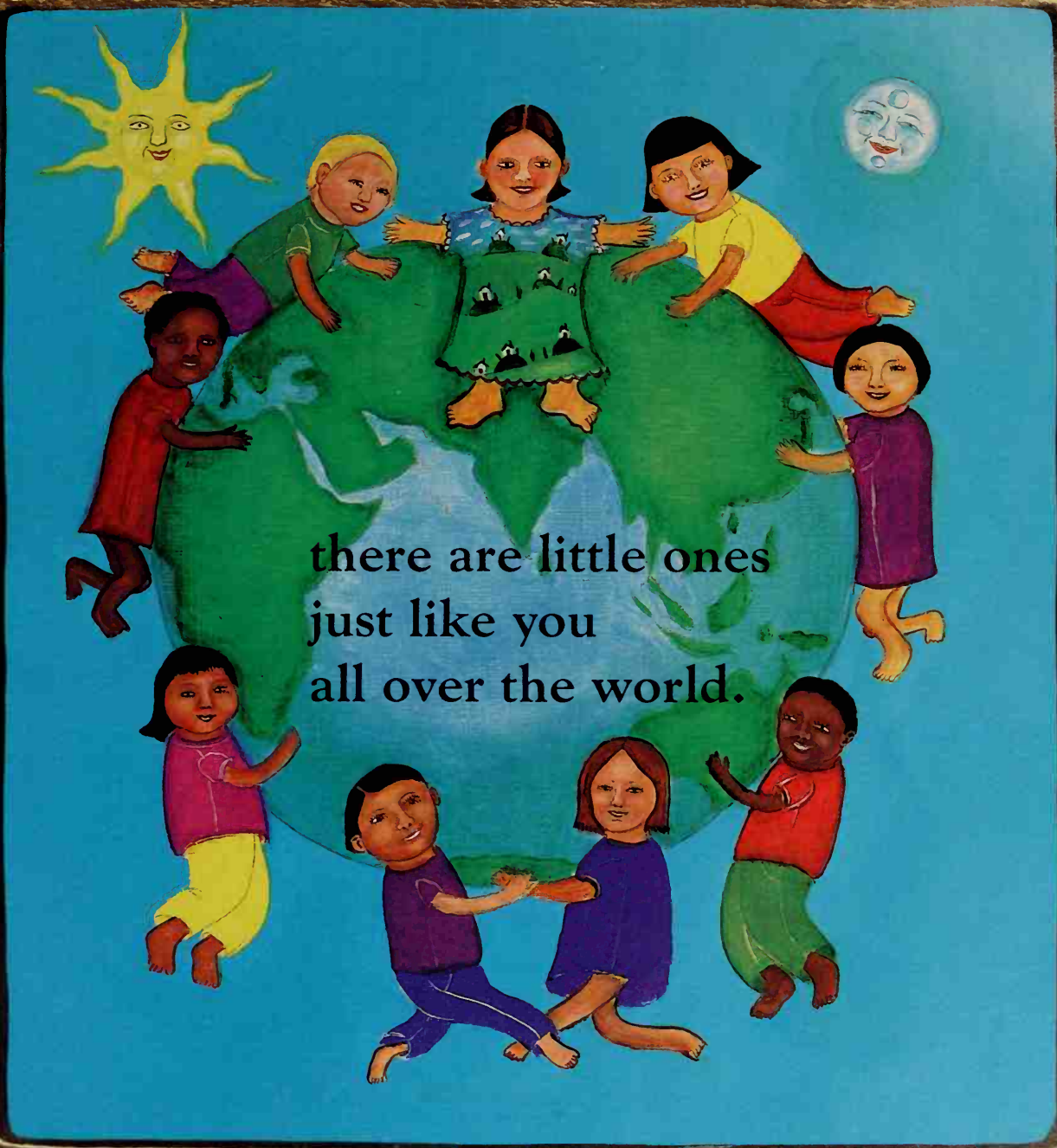
<http://www.archive.org/details/whoeveryouare00foxm>



Little one,
whoever you are,

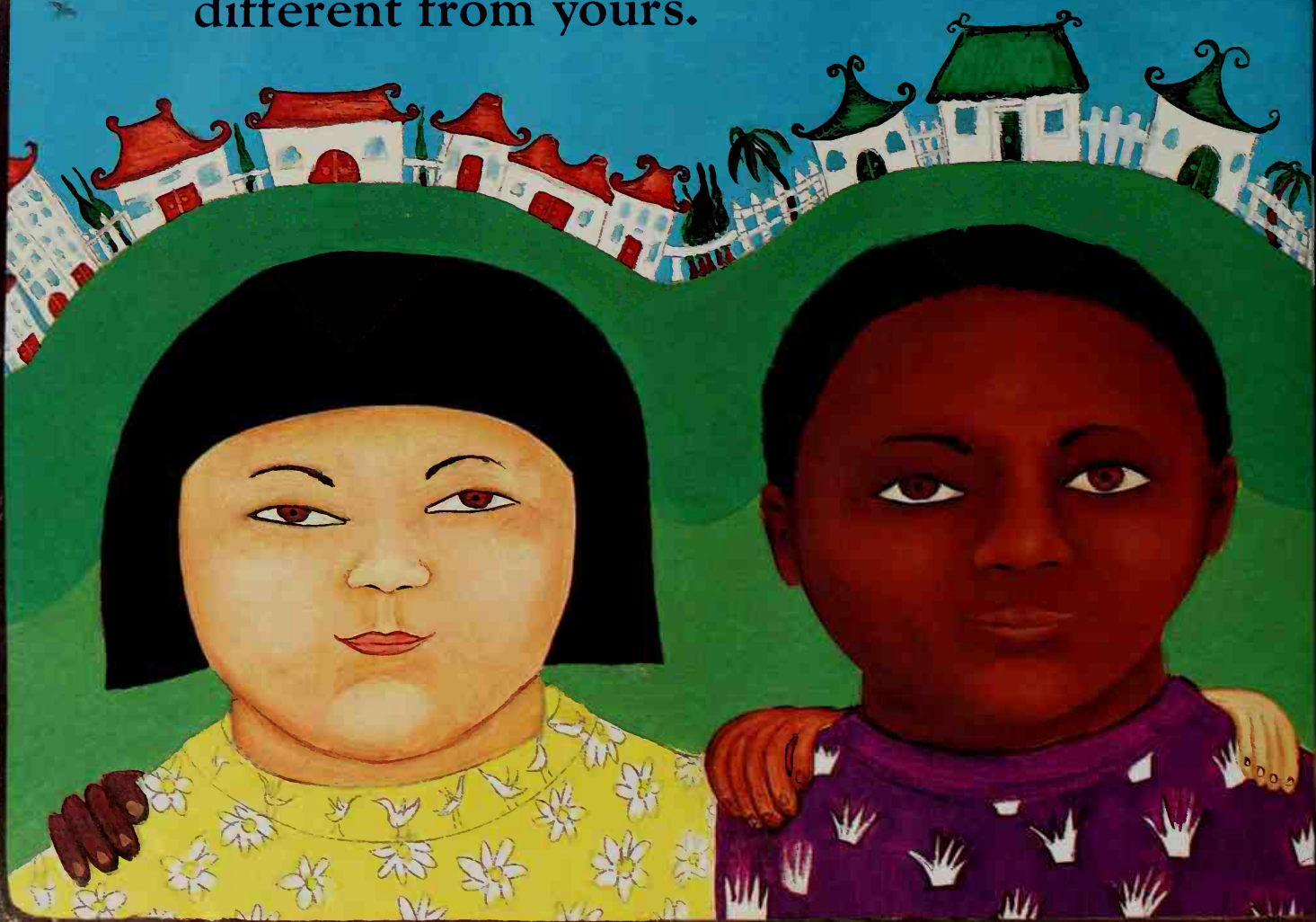


wherever you are,

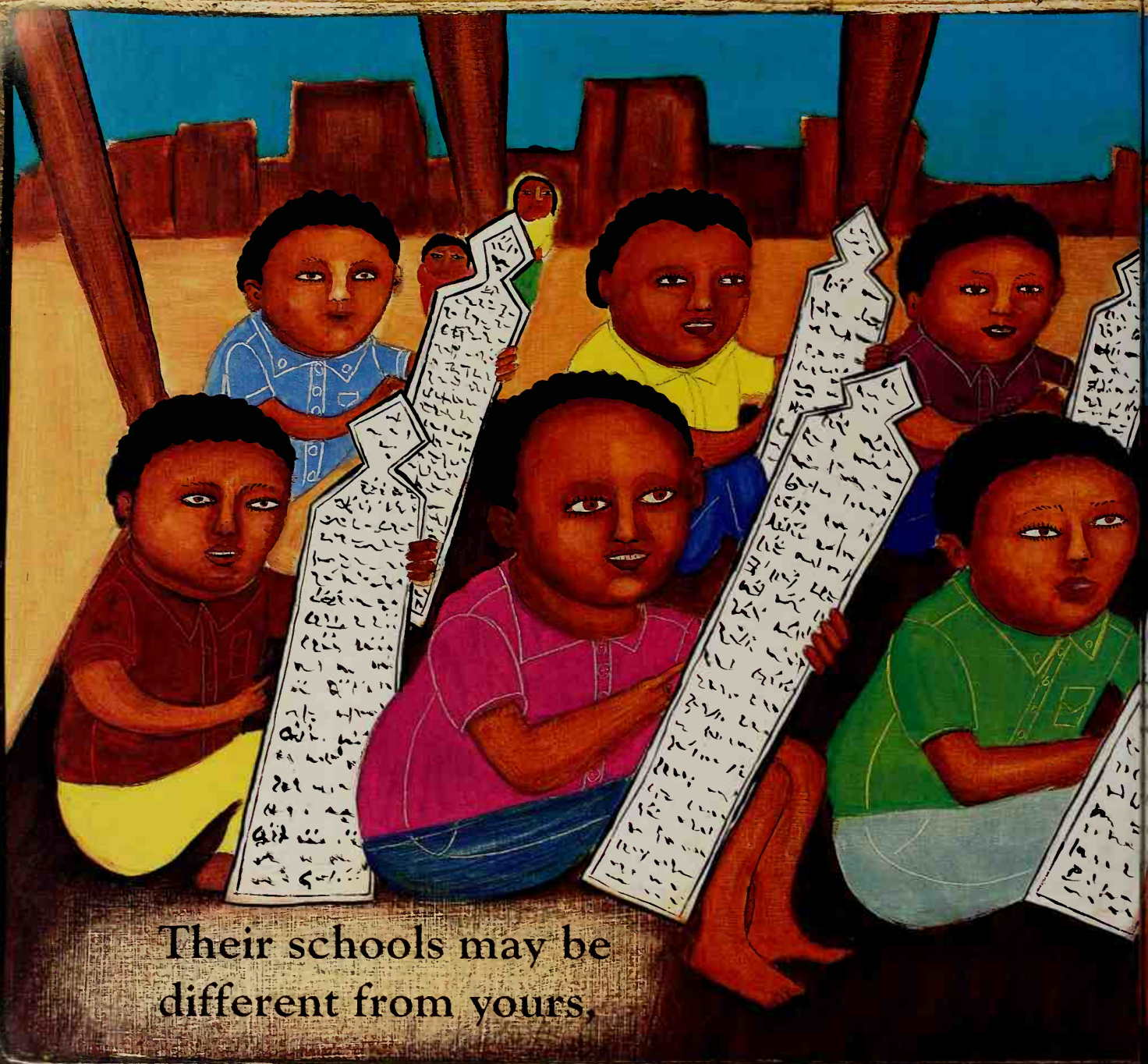


there are little ones
just like you
all over the world.

Their skin may be
different from yours,
and their homes may be
different from yours.



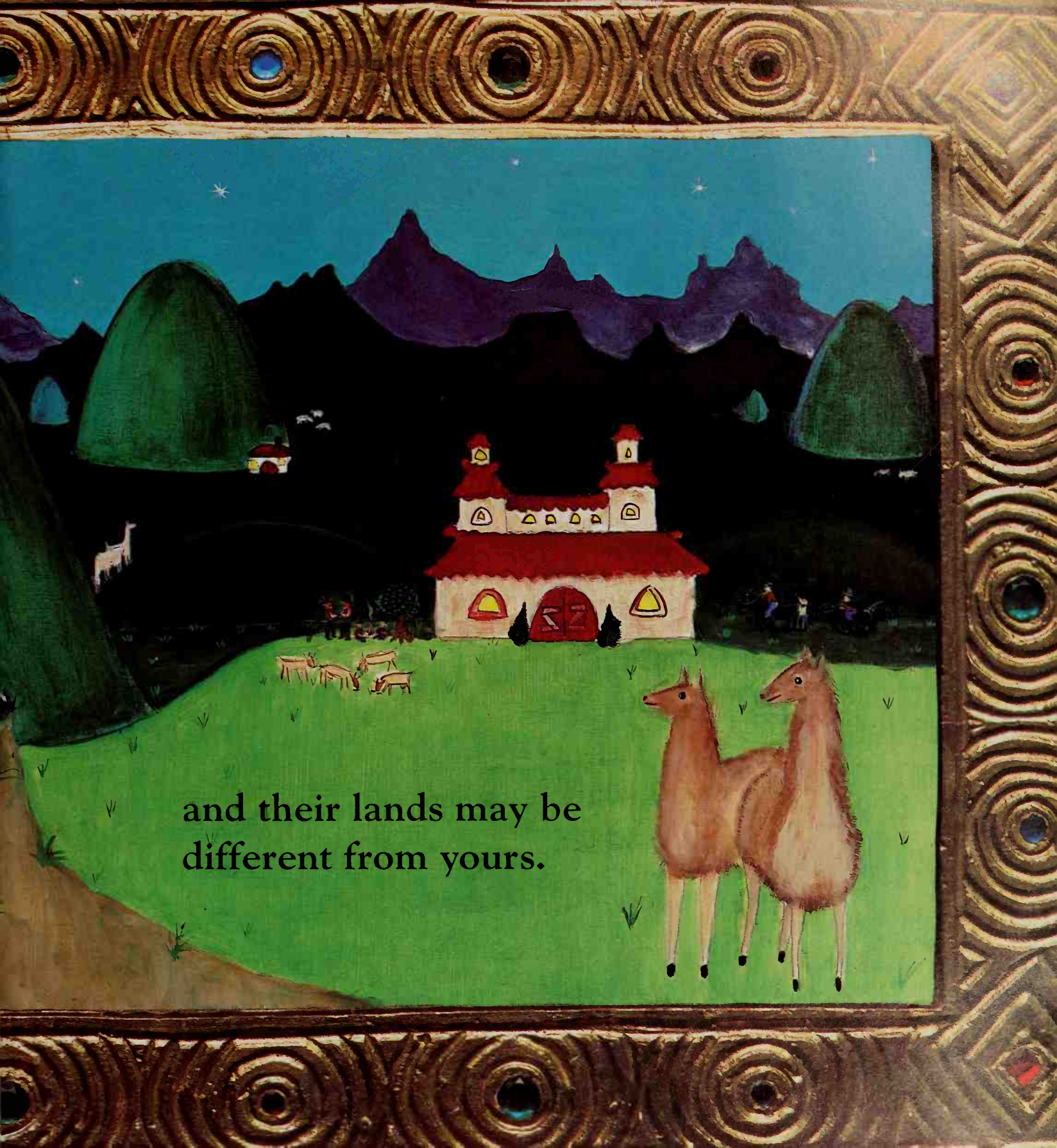




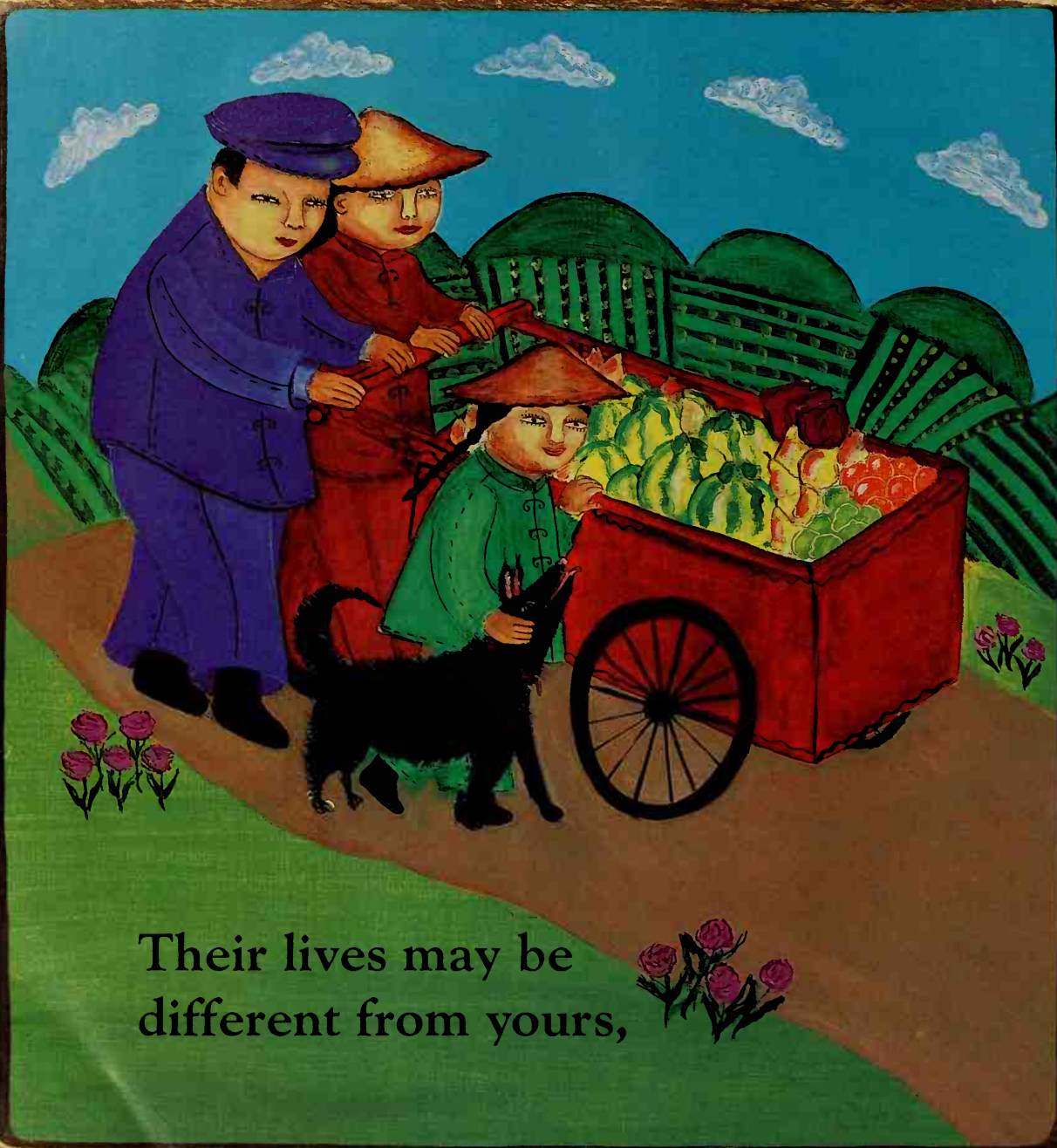
Their schools may be
different from yours,







and their lands may be
different from yours.



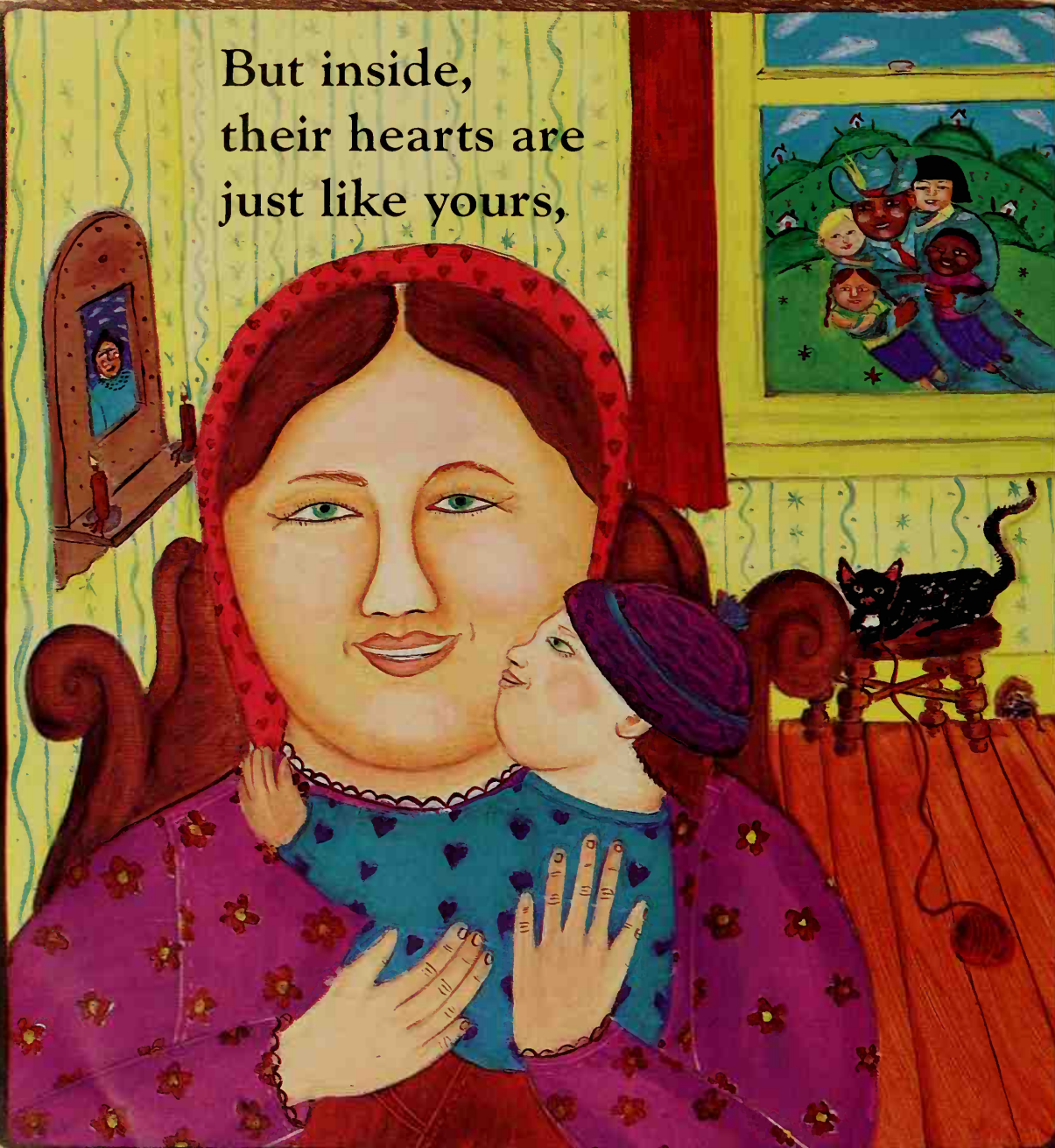
Their lives may be
different from yours,



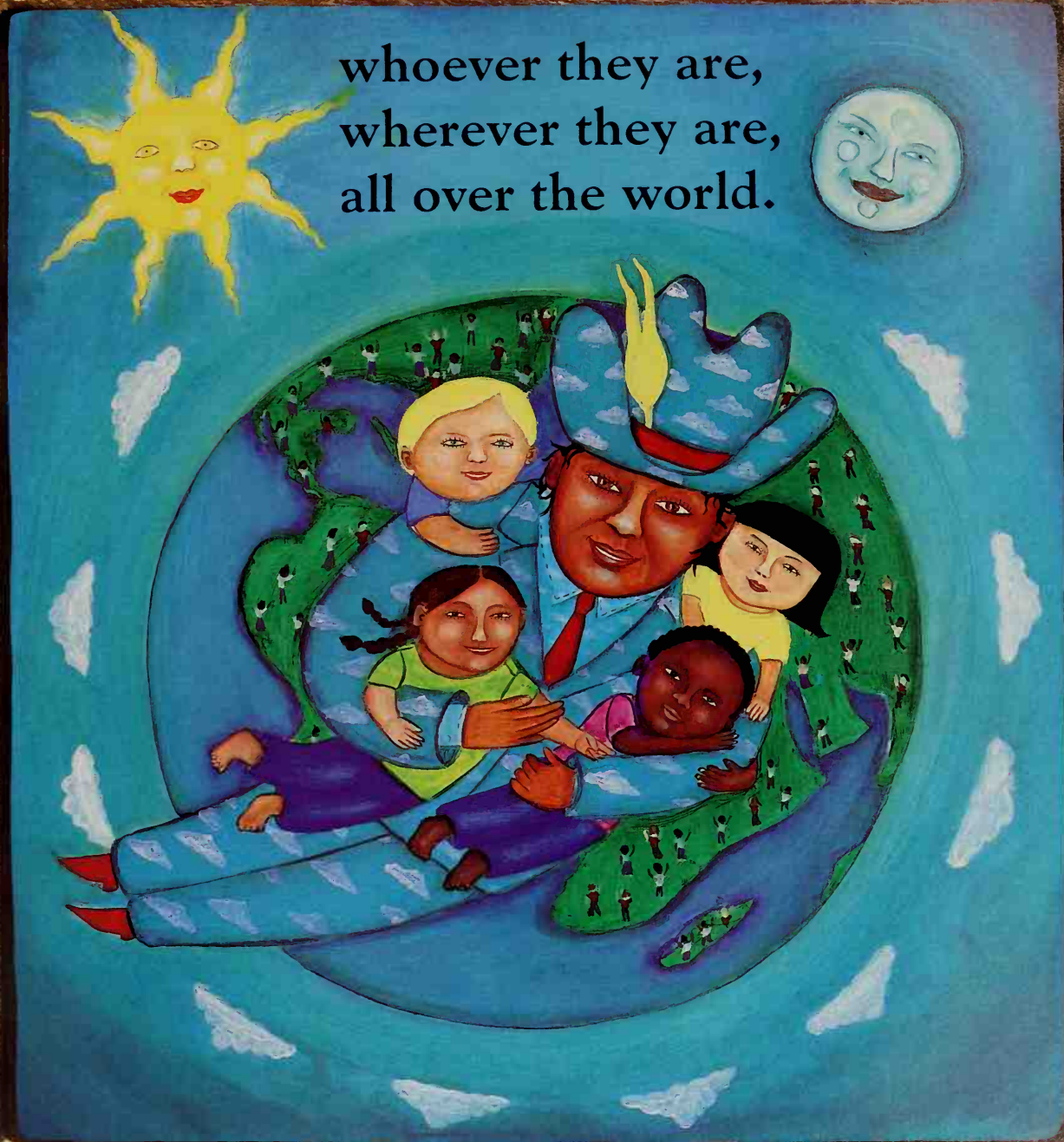


and their words may be
very different from yours.

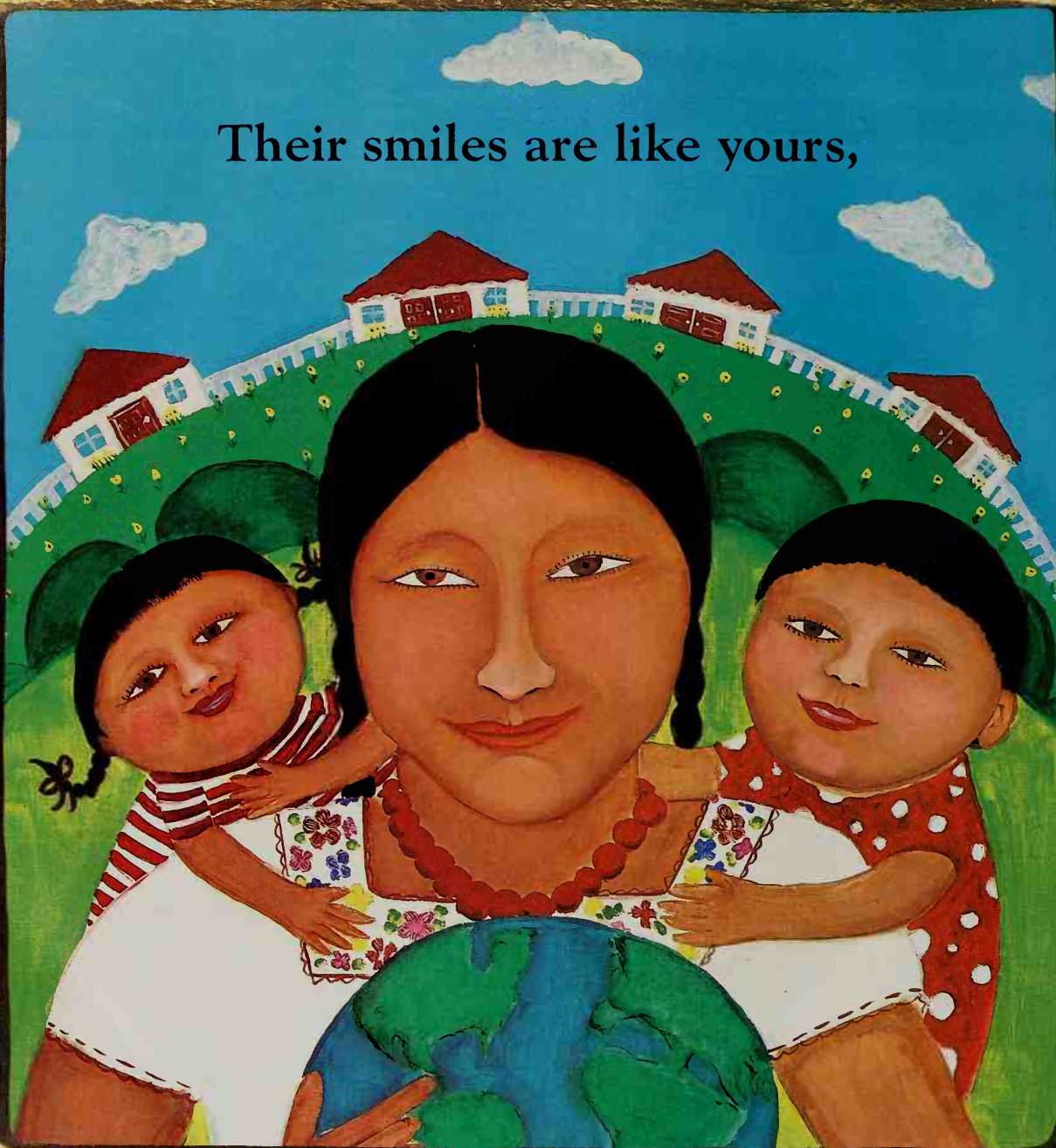
But inside,
their hearts are
just like yours,



whoever they are,
wherever they are,
all over the world.



Their smiles are like yours,



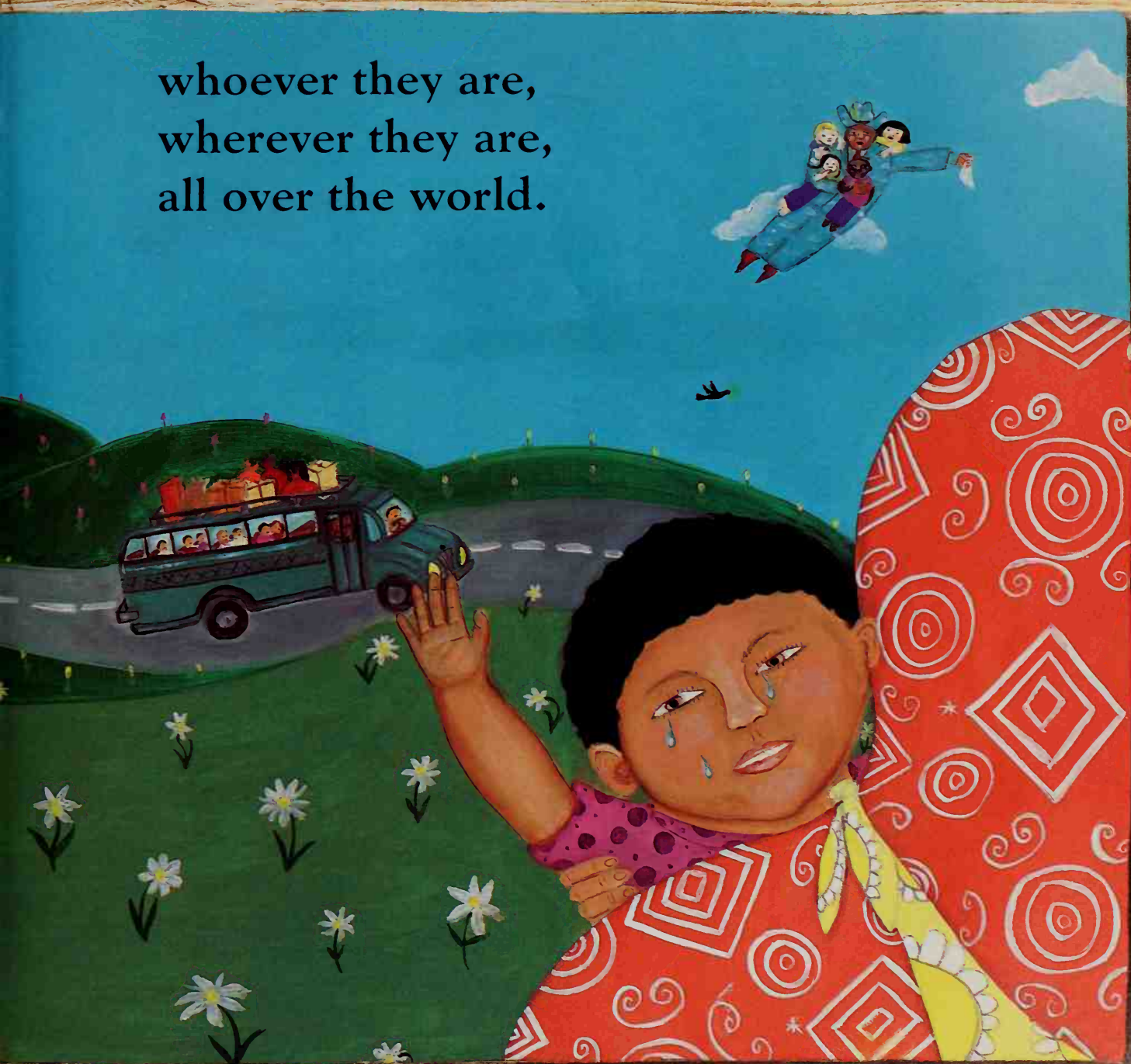
and they laugh just like you.

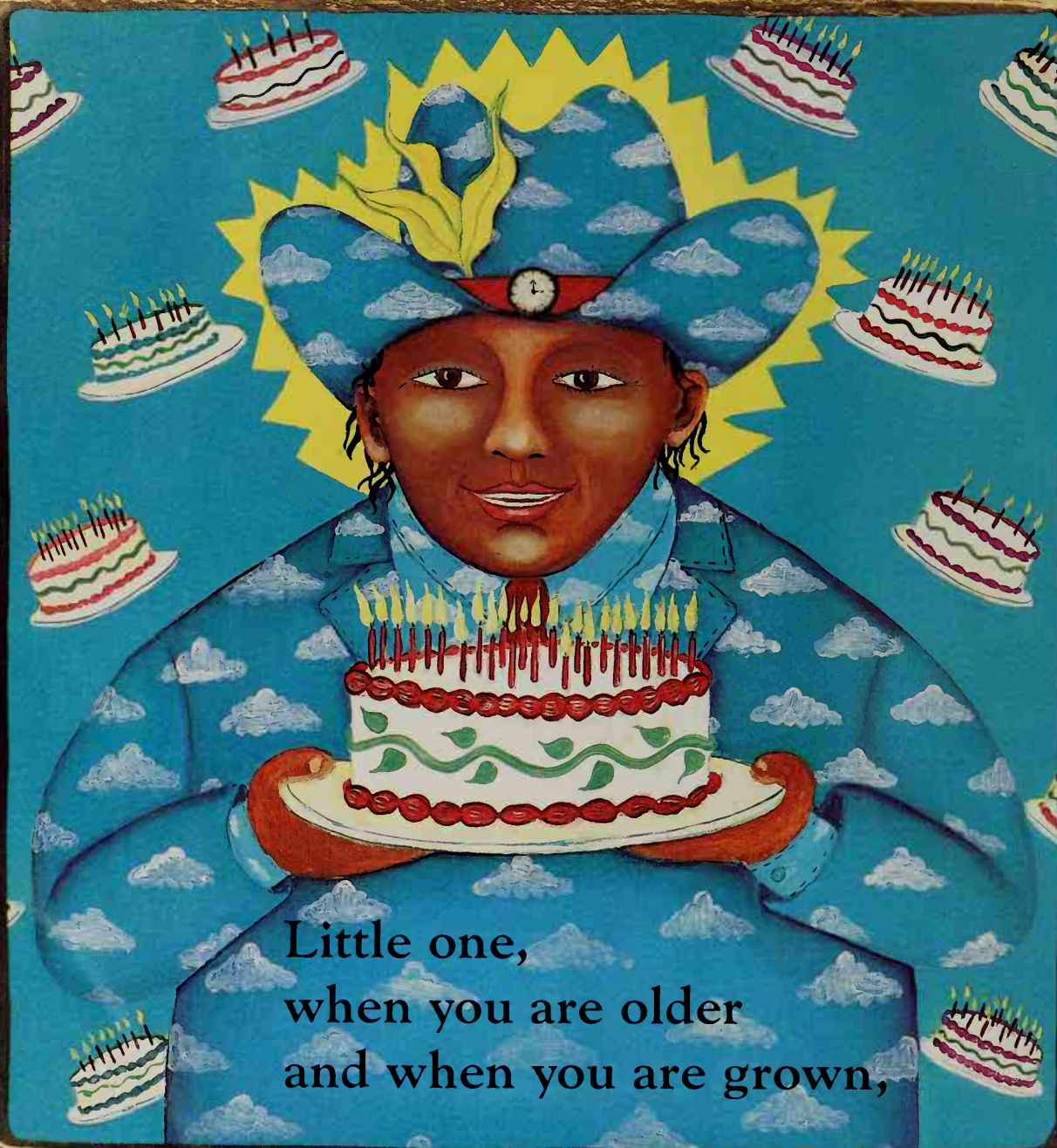


Their hurts are like yours,
and they cry like you, too,



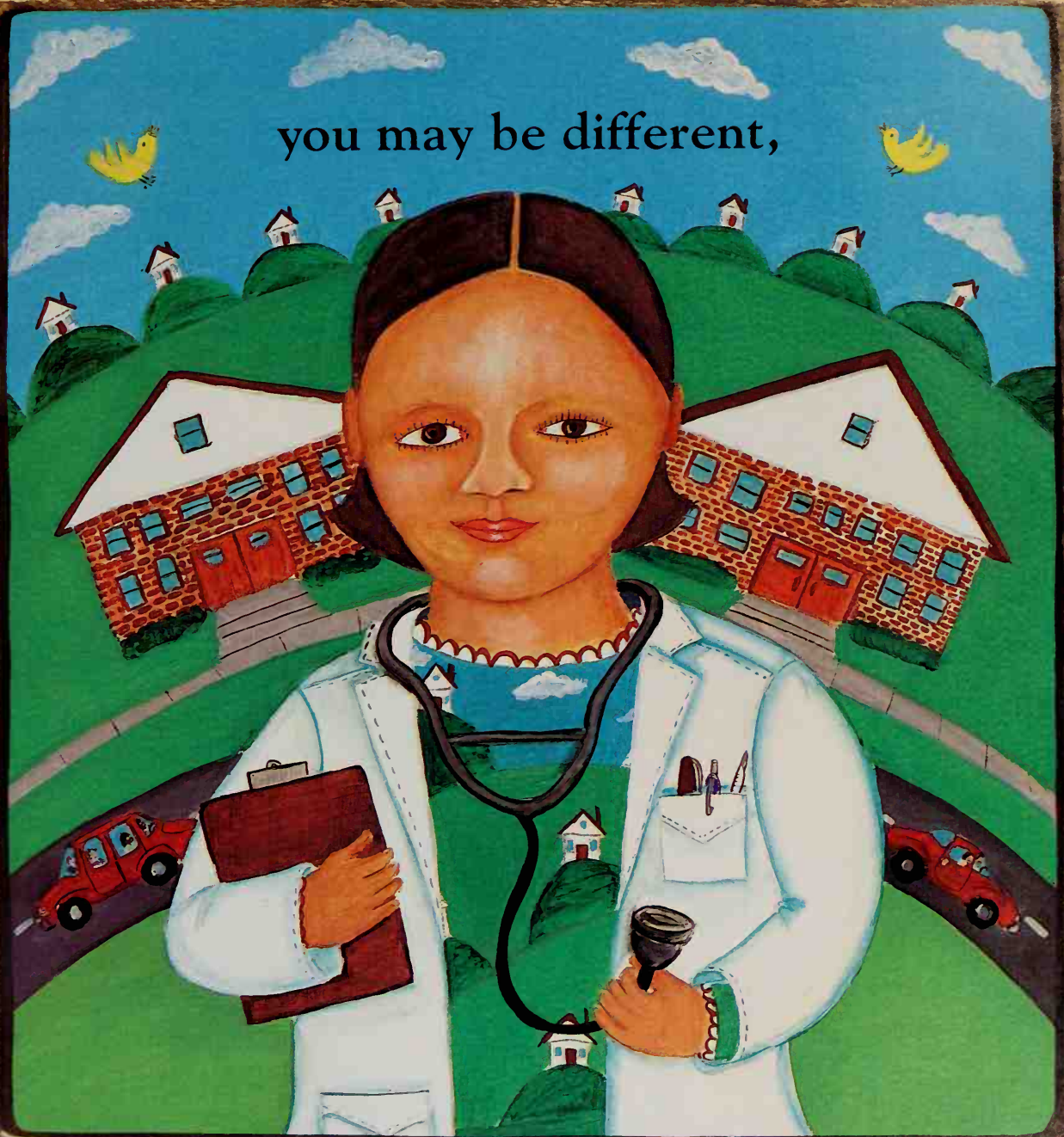
whoever they are,
wherever they are,
all over the world.



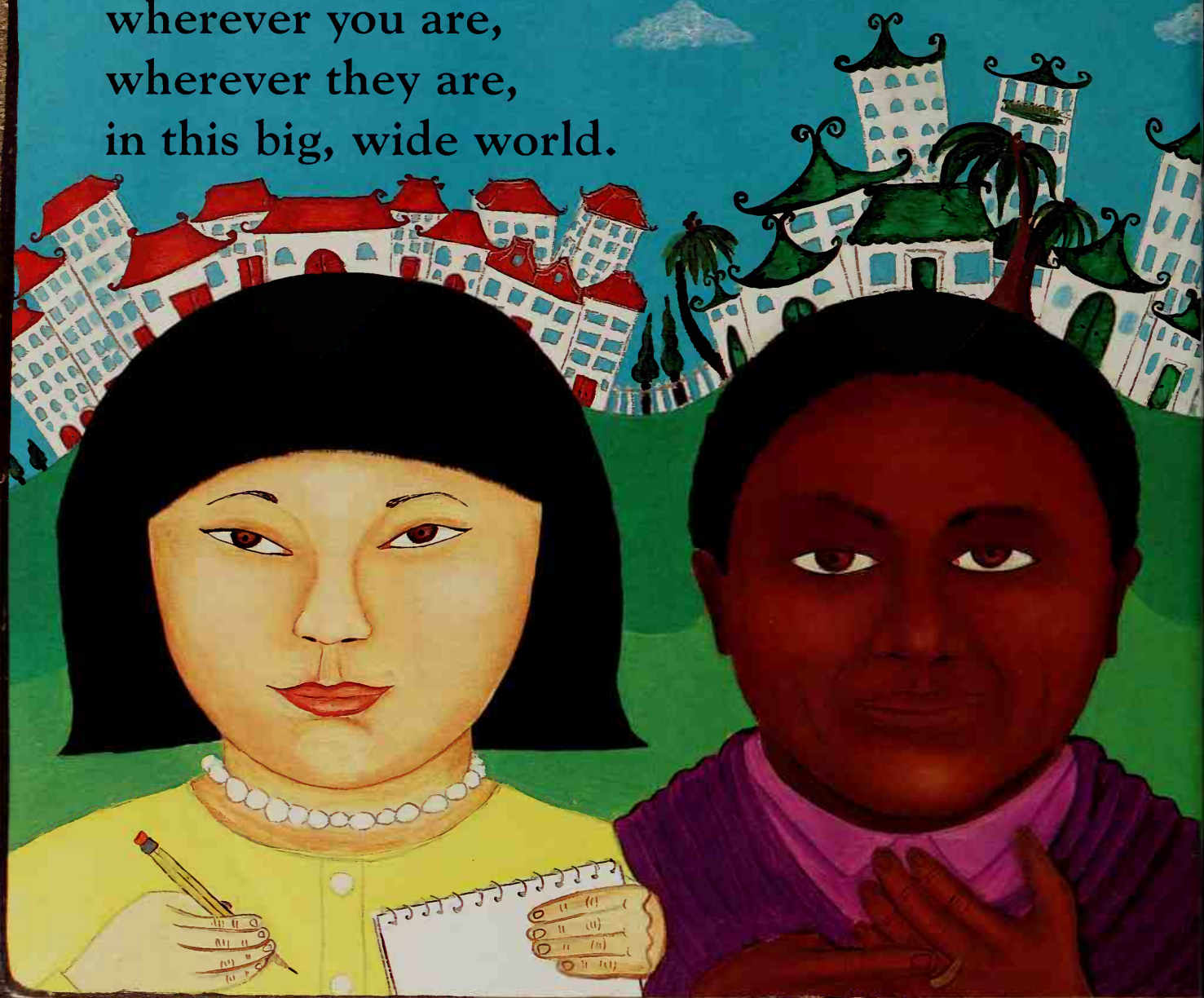


Little one,
when you are older
and when you are grown,

you may be different,



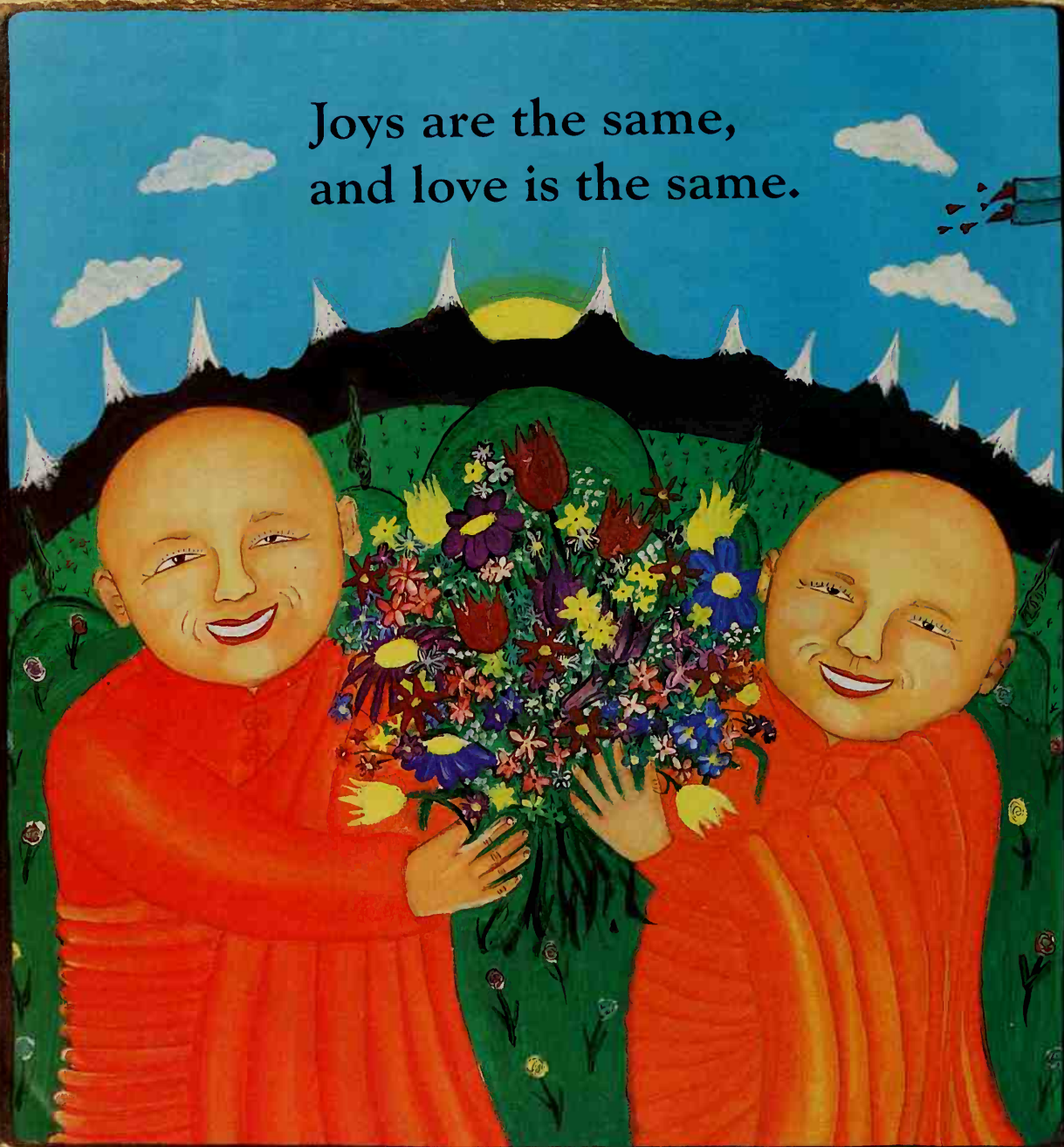
and they may be different,
wherever you are,
wherever they are,
in this big, wide world.

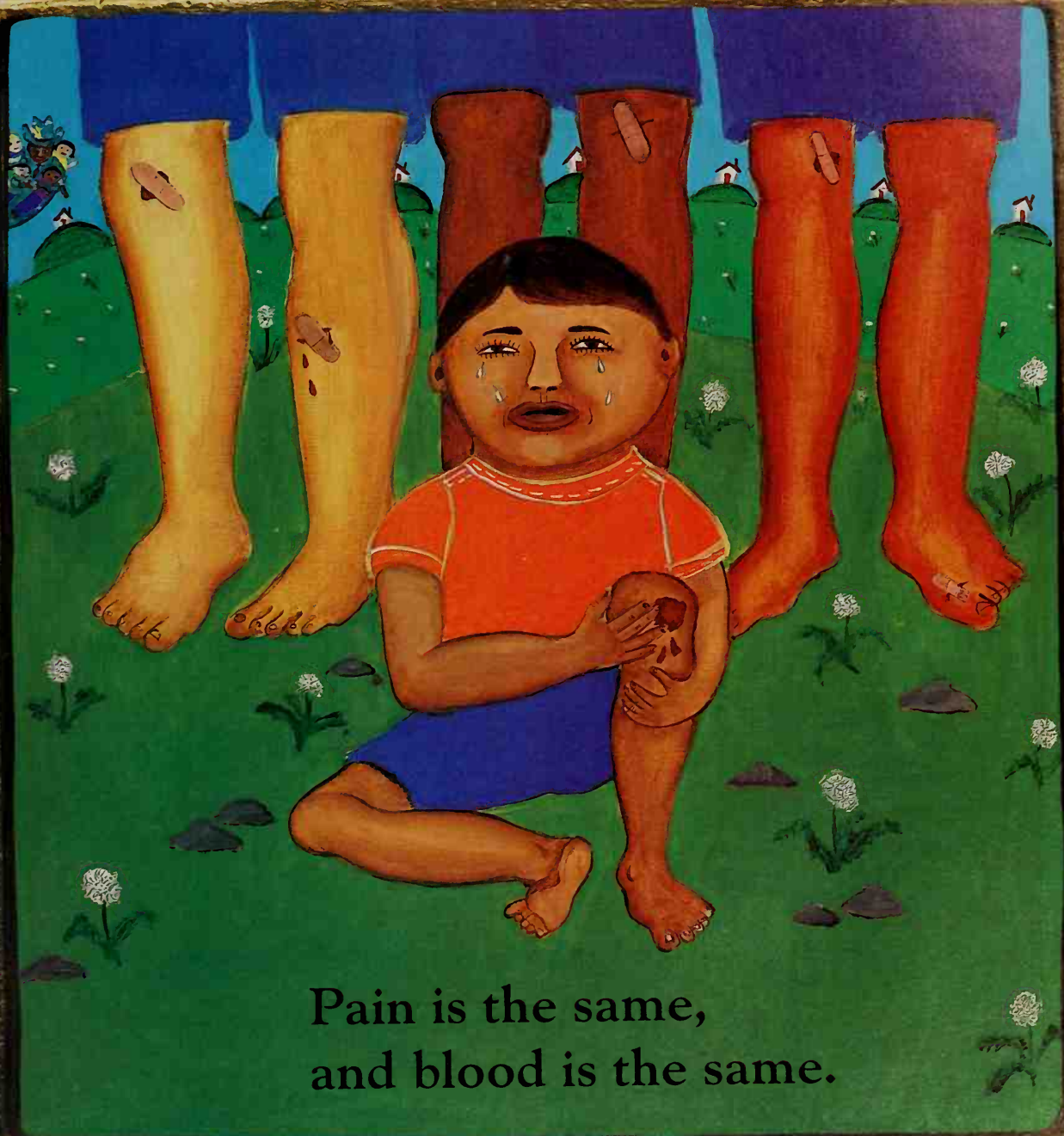


But remember this:



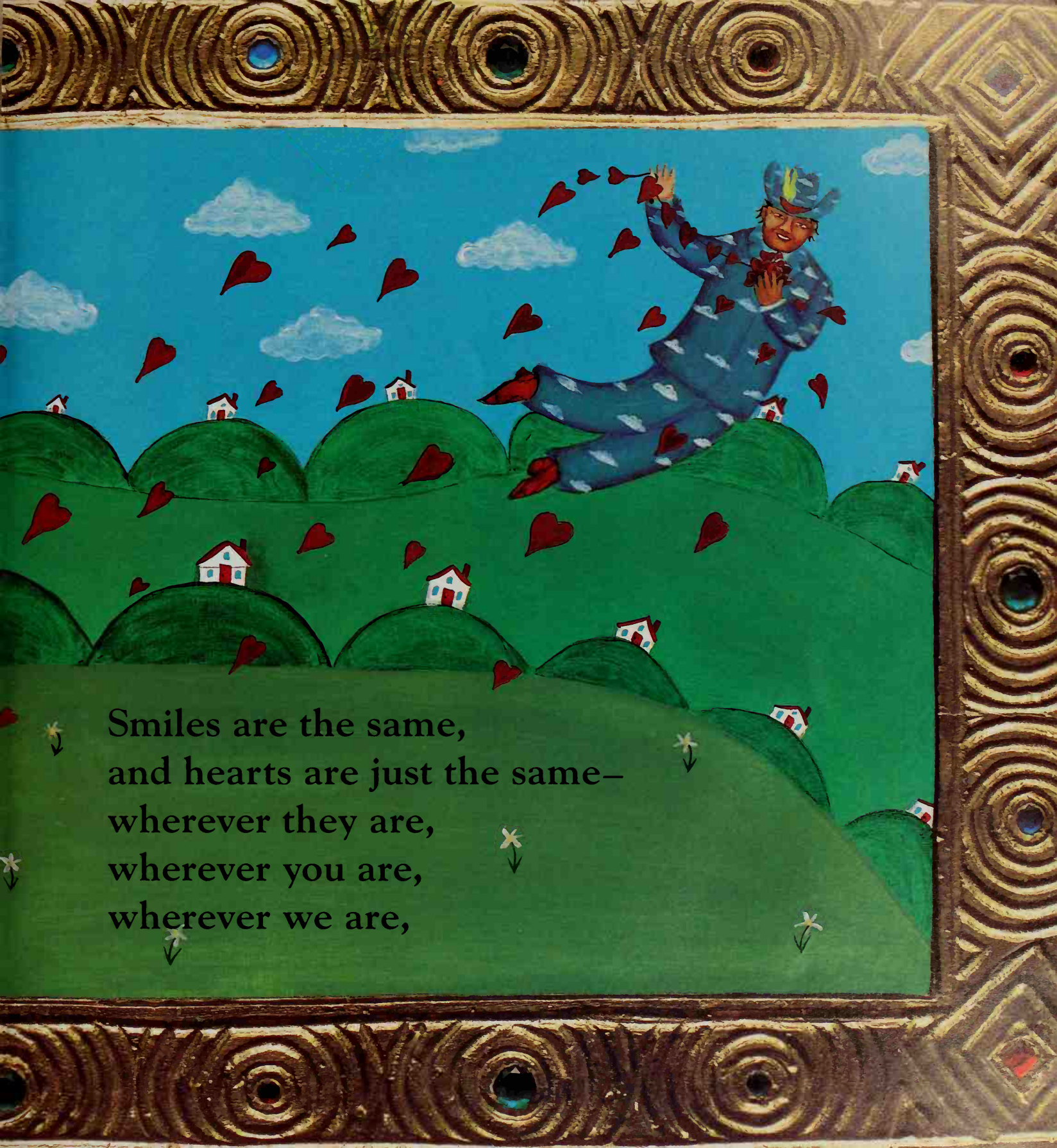
Joys are the same,
and love is the same.





Pain is the same,
and blood is the same.





Smiles are the same,
and hearts are just the same—
wherever they are,
wherever you are,
wherever we are,



all over the world.

"An essential book that acknowledges in the simplest of terms
our common humanity"—*Kirkus Reviews*



This edition is only available
for distribution through the
school market.

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